

Derek Adler, thirty-four, is married and lives in Bridgewater, New Jersey. Derek and his wife are both scientists. Derek blames his Adult Attention Deficit Disorder (AADD) for his avid coupon use. The same disorder that allows him a hyper-focused attention to details in his work with a major pharmaceutical company gives him a decided advantage when it comes to couponing. After all, it is the strategic moves of combining sales prices with coupons that allow him to stockpile enough good deals to donate to the local food bank and two animal shelters.

Derek's used coupons for years, getting heavily involved since March 2009, when he discovered he could save over 90 percent on their grocery bill. That month, he'd lost his coupon folder in the same week their local A&P offered a triple coupon event. He went through their newspapers and cut out every single coupon 99 cents and under. With just those in hand he was still able to buy a hundred dollars worth of groceries for just under ten dollars. That did it. He was hooked on the super savings that can be had with coupons. Since then he cuts out every coupon, filing them in two thirty-three-page accordion folders.

He doesn't mind letting co-workers and friends know about his new coupon obsession because they will save their coupon inserts for him. He admits that while some of his friends might think he is nuts for couponing, they still like to hear how much he saved at the store that week.

Because of his couponing endeavors he, and his wife have enough deodorant, shampoo, toothpaste, peanut butter, and other non-perishables to last a full year or more—a stockpile that came in handy when he was temporarily unemployed last year. His biggest couponing feat was in 2011